

KALE REALTY

TRUST IN AI HOME SEARCH JUST DROPPED 14 POINTS.

Trust in a human for the mortgage went up.

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**ONLY 16 PERCENT
OF BUYERS NOW
TRUST AI TO HELP
THEM FIND A
HOME.**

A year ago it was 30 percent, and it's still falling.

THE AI THEY TRUST LEAST IS THE ONE CLOSEST TO THEIR MONEY.

Cotality's 2026 AI in Housing survey found trust in AI for home search fell from 30 percent to 16 percent in a year, while the share of buyers who prefer a human for their mortgage rose from 46 percent to 55 percent. Buyers will let AI suggest a neighborhood. They won't let it near the number that decides what they can actually afford. The agents who lean into that gap, instead of competing with the AI on search, are the ones buyers still call first.

WHAT THIS CHANGES ABOUT HOW YOU MARKET YOURSELF:

- 1 Stop competing with the portal.**
Buyers already trust AI more than you for the first scroll through listings. Fighting that is a losing position.
- 2 Lead with the mortgage conversation, not the listing tour.**
That's the exact moment buyers say they want a person, not a model.
- 3 Put your name next to a lender's, not a search feature's.**
Trust transfers between people. It does not transfer between apps.

THE TAKEAWAY

BUYERS DIDN'T STOP TRUSTING AI EVERYWHERE.

They stopped trusting it with the part that matters most.